



Mens Intermediate AG4
4 x Per Week



1 Year Of Programming

This is a year of programming, 4x a week for busy men.

Goals Of Program:

Designed to aesthetically improve your body composition rapidly and build a strong, pain free base for sports or everyday life, with good posture.

Training Approach:

This program uses a PUSH PULL LEGS + ONE FULL BODY DAY approach in order to maximise growth. Workouts are designed to focus on getting you in the gym and beating your record on a few key compound movements that aesthetically grow your body rather than spreading your time and energy over many different complicated exercises. The Push Pull Legs are completable in 30 minutes and the Full Body will take slightly longer.

Who Is This Program For?

This programme is for busy people who want to workout, but don't have much time. You could have children, be going through a very busy period at work, or simply have a lot going on in your life, but still want to build an aesthetic body. This is a great and worthwhile goal.

Can I Really Build A Good Looking Body In 30 Minutes?

Yes, if you are consistent and focus in the gym. You make 90% of your gains through progressing compound exercises in the first 30 minutes of a workout where you have the energy to hit records on them. The other 10% is achievable from advanced programming and longer workouts. Compound movements recruit more muscles at once and so cause the majority of your growth in the gym. The good thing about 30 minute workouts is they aren't overwhelming and are easy to focus on.

As long as you are consistent, and focused on setting records each session, paying more attention to this than other people in the gym who are doing long sessions and sitting on their phone between sets, not really focusing on progression, you will craft an amazing body.

In fact, most people are going to gain more on 4 consistent short sessions a week where they actually attend sessions and hit records on compound movements than those that chose complicated plans that aren't right for them. There is the rare type of person who can commit to an advanced programme, and they can get the rewards of 10 - 15% extra growth. That extra growth can be the difference between a great looking male model body that has visible abs, and a social media influencer type body with chiseled abs and slightly larger muscles. Essentially taking you from from an already brilliant physique to a top 10% of men type physique.

But yes, you can still do 90% of the work on this programme, and build an amazing, lean, beach body physique with visible abs on 4 sessions a week, and the reality is this: most people will work harder doing 4x a week doing 30 minute easy workouts than advanced programs. This is because short workouts are easy to focus and work hard on, directing just enough energy without leaving a person exhausted or demotivated.

When To Move To An Advanced Programme?

Specific people will do well on advanced programmes and actually be able to be consistent. If you aren't this type of person you will do better on the 30 Minutes For Busy Workouts programme.

For the rare type of person who has built the foundations of conditioning their body and has an understanding of fitness, and who has time, an advanced programme becomes an option. For an advanced programme, you need 3 things:

- Time
- A passion for fitness
- Experience on a fundamental programme first to prepare your body and mind.

If you have these 3 things, evaluate your physique and your lifestyle. If you're happy with your results and still have limited time, you can continue on the 30 Minute For Busy People workouts programme for life. You will still achieve a great beach body, male model type physique on this programme.

If you now have more time and find you want that extra bit of size, more muscular detail, a stronger-looking six-pack, or the physique of a hardcore bodybuilder or fitness influencer, the extra 10%, that's when I'd recommend moving onto something more advanced, but you will need to spend more time in the gym and be motivated to do so. You should build that foundation through following this programme.

Essentially, run this programme for a year or two, and then ask yourself: "Am I happy with my physique, or do I want that little bit more?" And decide based on your goals.

The Mindset To Have

The mindset to have is that because you only have 30 minutes, you have all your energy concentrated. You aren't putting yourself through the same stresses as others who are overworking themselves on long programmes. Because it isn't a long workout, it is easy to hit your goals. You have the energy and enthusiasm to go in, hit some records, and go home. And you will find it easy to hit those records, as you don't have 8 different exercises to succeed on, so you have enough energy, before you get fatigued or bored.

Nearly everyone can hit a 30 minutes workout, even if they have had a long day. Go in for a quick easy session, and then leave. Do this 4 times a week even on the days you feel 70% energy. Go through the motions. Enjoy it. Just tell yourself its only going to be a quick session, drop off a set here and there if you need to, leave early if you need to, keep sessions low pressure.

Get yourself in the gym. The truth is the session times are so short that this programme will be manageable even on the days you feel bad. Even on your tired days, you may not hit records on every exercise, you may leave early, but you will still likely will hit a record on at least one exercise.

Can you imagine how you will look in a year of personal records being hit EVERY session 4 times a week, on key exercises that grow you? Consistency is key!

The Secret To Gaining In 30 Minutes

Most people waste time between sets, get distracted on their phones, follow unnecessarily complicated programmes, or continue training long after their useful energy has dropped. People do these things because they aren't having fun or distracting themselves because they know they have a long time left of their workout and aren't feeling it. You aren't going to do that. Because you know you have a fast, easy session ahead of you. Thats the secret.

Consistency 4 times a week, in short manageable bursts, giving you lots of physical and mental recovery time. Each session just go in, don't get distracted, and hit your Personal Records each week.

Which will be easy because you will be completing short, simple sessions with all your energy, and not many exercises to hit records on.

The real skill you are developing over this year is learning how to make limited training time count. On a programme like this, it will feel unfair on others because you will gain faster than others whilst working out for LESS TIME. And you will still have fun doing so, you don't even have to use 100% of your energy. These workouts are easy session wise. People will wonder how you are finding your workouts easier, and training for less time than them each week, yet getting better results.

It's simply that your consistently working smart in the right areas, giving yourself enough rest, whilst they waste time and fatigue themselves on programs that won't work for 99% of people. Who do you think gains more? A consistent person who hits records 4 x a week for a year, who manages recovery, or an inconsistent twice a week person who barely hits records and who falls off their programme often due to not being suitable for that programme? Of course the first.

How This Will Help You

Most people aren't suited for advanced training because they simply don't have the time, the passion built up, or the foundations built first that they can default back to on the hard days and mentally draining days. Fitness at an advanced level isn't just about following timetables, its about following how your body feels and knowing when to push and when to make an easy workout an option.

It is also about building a good basic effective programme into your muscle memory first and conditioning yourself, thats when when you add advanced concepts, you will know how to simplify your workouts back down when necessary on the low energy days, creating a flexible programme that you know off by heart.

This is what we aim to slowly build, we build your foundations first with the hope that one day, if you chose to take things to the next level, you will be ready for that. But for now, lets build your foundation before we add the advanced concepts. Let's get you working out effectively in the short time that you have.

Welcome to the Intermediate 30 Minute Workouts For Busy People.

Programme Explanation

Apply the Advanced Training Techniques to at least 3 - 5 of your sets per workout. If you need to learn the Advanced Training Techniques, check out the section at the end of this PDF for explanations and videos.

Also, as part of the intermediate programme this year, every month, you will learn a new cardio technique to expand your gym knowledge.

Each workout should take half an hour to 45 minutes and the cardio is optional. Should you chose to do cardio it should add around 15 to 20 minutes to the workout.

Reccommended Items:

- Gym Membership
- Set Of Resistance Bands

Video Guidance

Press the  button next to the exercises to access the video form of the exercises if you need help.

How Many Days A Week To Workout

For **3 days a week**, disregard this programme and select the Intermediate Upper Lower Supersets program. It is great for those who want to do 3 days a week full body training in a time efficient manner, similarly to how they train people in leading body composition gyms. Suitable also for athletes or those who train other sports who want to do no more than 3 sessions a week. However requires an hour of your time each session. If you really need to, you can do the Push Pull and Legs workouts from this current programme 3 times a week, but growth will come slower as you are only hitting each muscle group once per week, which isn't generally advised as the top choice for growth.

For **4 days a week**, there are two options:

Push Pull Push Pull. This completely avoids Legs and is Upper Body focused. This will accelerate your upper body like never before and suitable for men who want to focus on their upper body.

A more balanced approach is this:

Push Pull Legs, with one Full Body day. This is a very good balance to hit all muscle groups twice per week at 4 days per week. This is the option I recommend for this 4 days a week programme.

For **5 days a week**,

Push Pull Legs Push Pull is our choice of programme. From an aesthetic bodybuilding standpoint men are Upper Body focused when it comes to aesthetics and the one Leg session a week is enough.

The good thing about this 5 day a week setup is if you have a bad week and miss a day or so when doing PPL, you can make up for it by doing a full body session, and this will still hit all muscles twice that week.

For **6 days a week**,

Push Pull Legs Push Pull Legs. Sticking to such a split gets results extremely fast. Not only are you hitting all muscle groups twice a week, but you are giving the push pull and legs muscles 2 focused sessions each. In full body training your focus is spread out over many muscles, and you usually tire after the first few exercises, meaning full body training days can tire you before maximally working your entire body. With 2 targeted push pull legs a week, you are dialling in on those areas more effectively.

How To Warm Up For Push / Pull Day



Warm Up: Resistance Bands

Band Pull Aparts 20 reps.

Resistance Band Pass Throughs 10 reps.

Arm Circles 15 seconds per direction.

2 Sets Hanging From Bar 10seconds each



Click to watch video

How To Warm Up For Leg Day

Warm Up: 2 minutes Treadmill

Bodyweight Squats 10 reps.

Hip Flexor Stretch 15seconds per leg.

Worlds Greatest Stretch 15seconds per side.



Click to watch video

Push Day (30 Minute)

Complete Your Push Day Warm Up

EXERCISES

Incline Dumbbell Press ▶

4x12

Dumbbell Shoulder Press ▶

Dropsets - In between every set do an extra 5 reps with a light Barbell

4x12

Lateral Raises ▶

Dropsets - In between every set do an extra 5 reps with either a cable machine, or resistance band.

4x15

Cable Triceps Pushdown ▶

Dropsets - In between every set do an extra 15 reps with Behind the Head Tricep Extension, either using a Cable, or Dumbbell .

4x12

ABS BLOCK

AG 6 Minute Ab Workout ▶

CARDIO

**Running, Swimming, Stair Climber, Exercise
Bike, Punch Bag (Choose 1)**

Pull Day (30 Minute)

Complete Your Pull Day Warm Up

EXERCISES

Assisted Pull Up Machine ▶

3x12

Cable Row ▶

3x12

Lat Pull Machine ▶

3x12

EZ Bar Bicep Curl ▶

3 x 15

Military Dropsets

Rear Delts Machine ▶

3x15

ABS BLOCK

Back Extension ▶

3x Until Failure

CARDIO

**Running, Swimming, Stair Climber, Exercise
Bike (Choose 1)**

Leg Day (30 Minute)

Complete Your Leg Day Warm Up

EXERCISES

Leg Press Machine ▶

4x12

Leg Extension Machine ▶

4x12

Lying Leg Curl Machine ▶

3x12

Seated Calve Raise Machine ▶

Superset with 15 repetitions of Standing DB Calf Raises

4x12

Shoulder Press ▶

3x12

Superset with 15 repetitions of Dumbbell Lateral Raises

ABS BLOCK

AG 6 Minute Abs Workout ▶

CARDIO

**Running, Swimming, Stair Climber, Exercise
Bike (Choose 1)**

Full Body Day

EXERCISES

DB Shrugs

Superset with 15 repetitions of Rear Delt Dumbbell Raises

3x12

Shoulder Press

Superset with 15 repetitions of Dumbbell Lateral Raises

3x12

Incline DB Bench Press

3x12

Assisted Pull Ups

3x12

Barbell Bicep Curls

Superset with 15 repetitions of Behind Head Cable Tricep Extensions

3x12

Squats / Leg Press

Superset with 15 repetitions of Dumbbell Calf Raises

3x12

ABS BLOCK

5 Minutes Decline Crunches

CARDIO

**Running, Swimming, Stair Climber, Exercise
Bike (Choose 1)**



AG4 MENS · 3x PER WEEK

Month 1

JANUARY

AG4 MENS · 3x PER WEEK

MONTH 1 TECHNIQUE

Speed Cardio

This is a cardio session that makes use of movements where we go as fast as we can. To truly go as fast as we can, we do not tire ourselves out with high repetitions, we do no more than 5 repetitions per set, and then do some active rest (light movement with a different exercise) before starting another speed set. This will make you faster athletically, to help you in any sports classes or exercise classes.



Click to watch workout video

Beginners Speed Cardio Workout

5 speed squats
30s light high knees (active rest)
(Repeat this combination 5 times and move on)
5 speed burpees
30second skipping on the spot
(Repeat this combination 2 times and then move on)
5 speed left hand punches
5 speed right hand punches
30 seconds marching on the spot
(Repeat combination 3 times and move on)
Shadowboxing Fast Punch Flurries 5 seconds
30 seconds light high knees
(Repeat this combination 3 times then finish)



AG4 MENS · 3x PER WEEK

Month 2

FEBRUARY

AG4 MENS · 3x PER WEEK

MONTH 2 TECHNIQUE

Interval Training

Pick a cardio machine or even two to switch between if you wish. Interval training is where you cycle between an easy (rest interval) and hard effort (work interval). To make learning this process as easy as possible,, we will rest for 30 seconds at an intensiy of 4 out of 10 and then work for an effort of 7 out of 10 for 30 seconds. Keeping it 30 and 30 makes things simple and easy to time.

Depending on your sport, interval times may change as some sports require longer or shorter work rest periods, but this is just a basic introduction. Intervals will push you slightly harder than a same speed Zone 2 run that you have been using for your cardio in the beginner programs. This results in your cardio improving. You become better at short bursts of exercise and become fitter at more intense exercise, which is important for your overall health.



AG4 MENS · 3x PER WEEK

Month 3

MARCH

AG4 MENS · 3x PER WEEK

MONTH 3 TECHNIQUE

Sprints

Sprints release a great amount of hormones which allow us to build more muscle. They hit a different energy system to long distance running and it is beneficial for our heart lungs and general health to be fit in this way too. This month, lets incorporate 10 sprints into our cardio, whether outside or on the treadmill.

10 x 15seconds Maximum Speed Sprints if outside.

10 x 25seconds Maximum Speed Sprints if on Treadmill (We give 10 seconds extra for the Treadmill to bring us up to our maximum speed as treadmills delay.)



AG4 MENS · 3x PER WEEK

Month 4

APRIL

AG4 MENS · 3x PER WEEK

MONTH 4 TECHNIQUE

HIIT

High Intensity Interval Training includes at least 10 minutes of highly intense exercises that bring you to around 80% of your maximum heart rate. This means at least one section in the workout must push you HARD for approximately 10 minutes. If it doesn't do that its not HIIT. Characteristic exercises of HIIT workouts include jump squats, burpees, and explosive exercises. Follow along a HIIT workout on YouTube or from this programme and ensure you push yourself to your true maximum for at least 10 minutes.



Click to watch workout video

HIIT Workout

30s High Knees
30s Burpees
30s Squat Taps
30s Plyo Lunges
30s Mountain Climbers
30s Squat Jumps
30s Jumping Jacks
30s Kettlebell Swings
30s Med Ball Slams
30s Plank Jacks
(2 rounds)



AG4 MENS · 3x PER WEEK

Month 5

MAY

AG4 MENS · 3x PER WEEK

MONTH 5 TECHNIQUES

Fartlek Training

This is free flowing training where you bring yourself up to 7 out of 10 effort, and then ease off slightly back down to a 5, then bring yourself back up to a 7-8 again multiple times in a workout. You don't time yourself or use intervals or any kind of plan, you push yourself based off of feeling alone. You can do this with any type of cardio machine. For 20 - 30 minutes this month, experiment with bringing yourself to a 7-8 intensity and back down multiple times in a 20-30 minute period. As you are on the Busy People's programme, aim for 15 minutes instead.



AG4 MENS · 3x PER WEEK

Month 6

JUNE

AG4 MENS · 3x PER WEEK

MONTH 6 TECHNIQUE

Long Distance Runs

This month, I want you to try to jog a 5k distance once per week. This is a longer run, pace yourself accordingly and go as slow as necessary to finish the distance. If you already run long distance, just go for your usual long run for the week.



AG4 MENS · 3x PER WEEK

Month 7

JULY

AG4 MENS · 3x PER WEEK

MONTH 7 TECHNIQUE

Boxing

Boxing and kickboxing are sports found to burn the most calories per hour. Most gyms have a punch bag or an open space to practice technique. The good thing about boxing is it uses your intelligence to learn new combos. There is always a new combo to learn, so your cardio can be fun, intellectual and you can learn a skill instead of just repetitively running on a treadmill or doing a circuit. Boxing can be great for days where your brain needs some stimulation and normal cardio seems boring.

If Boxing is not your thing, then your aim of this month is to go and try a new sport for at least 30minutes to an hour on your cardio days. You can run around shooting Basketball hoops, give Rock Climbing a try or go to a Swimming lesson. The aim is to find a form of cardio you genuinely enjoy, because then you will never have an issue sticking to cardio in your programming again.

Follow some beginners shadowboxing workouts on YouTube this month and if you wish to, buy some gloves and practice on a punch bag for 6 2 minute rounds, with a 2 minute skipping rope warm up.



AG4 MENS · 3x PER WEEK

Month 8

AUGUST

AG4 MENS · 3x PER WEEK

MONTH 8 TECHNIQUE

Metabolic Circuits

We are going to be using kettlebells to combine cardio with some explosive movements. These movements burn more calories than normal Zone 2 cardio. Essentially you burn more calories per hour which is good for your fat loss, but also you get the added benefits of some extra muscle because you are doing light and explosive forms of weightlifting as you do your cardio. This is a very productive and time efficient way of doing your cardio.



Click to watch workout video

Kettlebell Cardio Workout

Round 1:

Kettlebell Swings 30s

Kettlebell Snatches 30s

Double KB 5 burpee → snatch → clean

40 m heavy farmer carry

Round 2:

Russian Twists 30s

Kettlebell Mountain Climbers 30s

Kettlebell Squat Into Head Halo 30s

40m heavy farmer carry

Round 3:

Kettlebell Thruster 30s

Kettlebell Swings 30s

Kettlebell Deadlift Into Press Up x5

40m heavy farmer carry

Beginner: 1 repeat of full workout.

Intermediate: 2 repeats of full workout.

Advanced: 3 repeats of full workout.



AG4 MENS · 3x PER WEEK

Month 9

SEPTEMBER

AG4 MENS · 3x PER WEEK

MONTH 9 TECHNIQUE

Battle Ropes

Battle ropes improve your cardio whilst building shoulder and core muscles. There are many battle ropes workouts. If you do not have a conditioning area at your gym, then your challenge is to do 5 minutes of burpees at the end of every workout this month.



Click to watch workout video

Battle Rope Workout

Warm Up:

**1kg Dumbbell Shoulder Presses +
1kg Explosive Dumbbell Shoulder Push Outs**
(Push the Dumbbells straight out in front of you, and back to your chest, then push them straight up overhead and back to your shoulders, repeat these two exercises in a fast pumping motion for 1 minute.)

Workout:

Battle Rope Alternating Waves (Singles) (20s)

40s Active Rest

Battle Rope Waves (Doubles) (20s)

40s Active Rest

Battle Rope Slams (20s)

40s Active Rest

Battle Rope Star Jumps (20s)

40s Active Rest

Burpees into Battle Rope Slams (20s)

Active Rest Options:

Choose one of the following during each 40-second recovery period:

Step-Ups

High Knees

Russian Twists

Mountain Climbers

Duration:

Beginner: 1 Round

Intermediate: 2 Rounds

Advanced: 3 Rounds

Cool Down:

5 – 10 Minutes Treadmill



AG4 MENS · 3x PER WEEK

Month 10

OCTOBER

AG4 MENS · 3x PER WEEK

MONTH 10 TECHNIQUE

Power Cardio

Power cardio is training for explosive Power. Training for Power is similiar to training for Speed, we try to lift very fast. However, when we train for speed we lift as fast as we can with no resistance to slow us down.

Training for Power means we lift as fast as we can with weights added into the mix.

How does this help you? This training style builds our ability to move fast and powerfully under load, it means we do better in sports, and get a certain “look” about us of not just being big, but being powerful and capable. There is that subtle difference in physique to those who simply train weights and those who train to be functional at sports too.



Click to watch workout video

Power Cardio Workout

Warm Up:

Bodyweight Pogo Jumps 15 Reps Each Stance (Left Foot Forward + Right Foot Forward)
Flying Knees 15 Reps Each Stance

Workout:

Med Ball Knees x 6 Reps Each Knee
Dumbbell Pogo Jumps x 6 Reps Left Foot Forward
Dumbbell Pogo Jumps x 6 Reps Right Foot Forward
Med Ball Rotational Slams x 6 Reps Each Side
Decline Plank Leg Ups 8-10 Reps Per Leg
Med Ball Uppercuts 10 Reps Each Stance
Kettlebell Rotational Swings 14 - 20 Reps
Kneeling Squat Jumps x 6 Reps
Plyometric Lunges 6 Reps Per Leg
One Arm Dumbbell Press 8 Reps Per Arm



AG4 MENS · 3x PER WEEK

Month 11

NOVEMBER

AG4 MEN · 3x WEEK

MONTH 11 TECHNIQUE

HYROX Training

This is a trending fitness race that has exploded in popularity. This is a race you can train for in a gym and most gyms are equipped with the necessary equipment. It is good to train towards an goal instead of being aimless with cardio.

You could train for marathons or triathlons, strongman competitions, but HYROX is very accessible and most gyms are equipped with what is necessary to train for this race. The aim of HYROX is “functional fitness” which means you are training cardio and gym movements that work to make your entire body move better.

This prevents you only being good at one style of working out, and ensures your body is fit across multiple sports and movement patterns.

HYROX Workout

HYROX Workout 1:

A mini HYROX workout. The best way to train for a race is to drill the exact movements and stresses that your body will be placed under. A mini HYROX gets your body used to the transitions involved. This workout should take around 30mins.

200m run

300m SkiErg (*if no SkiRG: rower OR 20–30 med ball slams*)

200m run

Sled push – 25m (*if no sled: treadmill push 1 minute*)

200m run

Sled Pull – 25m (*if no sled: Kettlebell rows – 1 min continuous*)

200m run

Burpee broad jumps – 30m (*or 8–10 burpees if no space*)

200m run

300m row (*or 1 min bike if no Row machine*)

200m run

Dumbbell Farmer's carry – 50m

200m run

Sandbag lunges – 30m (*or DB lunges if no Sandbag*)

200m run

Wall balls – 30 reps (*or Dumbbell Thrusters if no medicine ball*)

HYROX Workout 2

This workout improves your pace on the SKI RG machine if this is a weak point for you.

First do a baseline test, see how fast you can complete 1000m on the SKI RG.

Divide that by 4 to get your 250m baseline time.

If your 1000m time is 2 minutes (120 seconds.) then divide 120 by 4 to get your baseline 250m time.

This would give us 30 seconds. Make this time 10% faster by multiplying it by 0.90.

$30 \times 0.90 = 27$ sec per 250 m target.

This is your new target pace for completing the intervals at.

Each workout do 8 Sets Of 250m on the Ski RG maintaining this new target pace.

Take 90 seconds of rest after each set of 250m.

Slowly change the rest times from 90 to 60 seconds over the weeks. You can keep some rest times at 90seconds and some at 60seconds each week, but try and eventually build up to 8 sets of 250m with a 60 second rest time between all intervals.

Even though the reps are broken up, you are completing 2,000 m total (double your race distance) at a faster-than-current pace, with controlled recovery.

It stands to reason that if you can complete double your race distance at 5 - 10% faster intervals than your current pace, broken up by 60s strategic rest times across 8 reps, you will be able to complete your total 1000m on race day at this 10% improved pace without taking rest.

HYROX Workout 3

If running is your weakness, complete a 45–90 minute easy steady run
During the run, complete a continuous 3 km speed block at any point (early, middle, or late in the session)

In this block perform 10 × 300 m fast efforts (0.3 km each)

After each 300 m effort, complete 100–200 m easy jog or 60–90 seconds easy recovery jog

All 10 reps should be controlled hard efforts, not all-out sprints

Aim to maintain consistent pace across all reps without significant drop-off

Using a watch press the lap button every time you start and finish .30 km to track the speed of each interval and improve on this run by run.

Total fast running volume = 3 km within the session (10 x 300m)

The purpose is to build running endurance, pace control, and fatigue resistance for HYROX.

This workout helps you repeat surges of speed under fatigue.



AG4 MENS · 3x PER WEEK

Month 12

DECEMBER

AG4 MENS · 3x PER WEEK

MONTH 12 TECHNIQUE

Zone 5 Cardio

Zone 5 is considered the most intense form of cardio because it pushes your heart rate to its absolute max. You are working at your maximum capacity, not 70 or 80%, but your true maximum effort. It is very hard to sustain your true maximum effort for more than around 10 minutes, perhaps even less depending on who you ask.

These sessions are very intense and only need to be used once a week. The way we practice Zone 5 in this program is to go between two cardio machines and rotate between 30 seconds of maximum effort between both of them..

Zone 5 Cardio Workout

Workout 1:

Assault Bike (30s)
Ski RG (30s)

Go between these two exercises at maximum effort and try to last between 6 minutes (beginner) to 10 - 15 minutes (advanced)

Workout 2:

Assault Bike (30s)
Punch Bag Jab Cross Hook Combo (30s)

Go between these two exercises at maximum effort and try to last between 6 minutes (beginner) to 10 - 15 minutes (advanced)

Advanced Training Techniques

You will notice on your programme card that it mentions applying 3 – 5 advanced training techniques from the exercise library per workout session.

Here are the advanced training techniques:

General Techniques:

Drop Sets

On your final set of a marked exercise, instead of stopping when you hit failure, immediately reduce the weight by around 20-30% and keep going. Drop the weight again and repeat for 3 drops total. Aim for 8-10 reps at each drop. You will see a small reduction in reps each time – this is completely normal. This month, look out for the green tick marker on specific exercises and apply this technique to your last set only.

Partial Reps

Partial reps are performed in the lower 25% of the range of motion: short, controlled pulses that maintain constant tension in the muscle. They are used at the end of a set, when full reps are no longer possible, to maximize muscle fatigue. After reaching muscle failure, perform 3 to 5 partial reps before lowering the weight. You can also perform partial reps with each rep of your set, doing 3 partial reps for every repetition. Try both methods often!

Pause Reps

Pause reps involve holding the weight completely still at the most difficult part of the movement—usually at the bottom—for 3 to 4 seconds before continuing. This eliminates momentum, forcing the muscle to work under pure tension. Include a 4-second pause on every repetition. Use a slightly lighter weight than usual to compensate for the increased difficulty.

Slow Reps

Slow repetitions involve controlling each phase of the movement with a tempo of 4 seconds on the lift and 4 seconds on the lowering of the weight. Think: 4 seconds up and 4 seconds down. This method increases time under tension, improves muscle control, and makes the muscle work harder during each repetition. Use this technique on every repetition. Slightly reduce the weight to maintain proper technique and controlled movement throughout the set.

Pre-Exhaust

Pre-Exhaust involves performing an isolation exercise immediately before a compound movement with no rest in between. This fatigues the target muscle first, ensuring it reaches maximum exhaustion during the compound exercise instead of letting other muscles do more work. A classic example is doing leg extensions before squats—your quads will already be burning when you start squatting, forcing the muscle to work harder. There is also Dumbbell Flys before Dumbbell Chest Press, or Lateral Raises before Dumbbell Shoulder Press.

Post-Exhaust

Post-exhaustion is the reverse of pre-exhaustion. You hit the compound movement first to recruit maximum muscle fibres, then immediately follow it with an isolation exercise to finish off the target muscle completely with no rest in between sets. For example, Leg press followed immediately by Leg Extensions ensures the quads are fully worked even after the glutes and hamstrings have taken some of the load in the compound.

Myo Reps

Myo-reps are a training method where you take a set close to failure, then rest for about 5–10 seconds and do 5 more reps. After that, you rest again for 5–10 seconds and do another 5 reps. You repeat this cycle around 3 times, or until you can't keep the reps clean anymore. You can use this technique on your last set of an exercise or every set, experiment with what works for you.

Pyramid Training

Pyramid training means adjusting your weight and reps across 4 sets in a structured pattern. An ascending pyramid starts lighter with higher reps and builds to heavier weight with lower reps — great for warming into a heavy movement safely. A descending pyramid starts heavy and works back down — good for pushing strength early when you are freshest. Rep schemes for upward pyramid: 6 8 10 12. Rep schemes for downward pyramid 12 10 8 6. Squats are a great exercise for this type of training.

Run The Rack

The Run The Rack technique is where you finish your last set, and then keep pulling out the pin and switching to the next lowest weight and you continue doing repetitions without rest, and then every time you fatigue you pull out the pin and go one weight lower until you reach a weight of 0. You can do this on machines by pulling out the pin and setting a lower weight each time, or on the dumbbell rack by picking up a lighter pair of dumbbells until you reach the lowest weight on the dumbbell rack.

Tri Sets

Tri Sets chain three exercises together with no rest between any of them — only the time it takes to move between stations. This is one of the most intense techniques in the library. The idea is to keep switching to a slightly easier exercise as you fatigue, meaning the muscle stays under tension for far longer than a normal set. Hit each exercise to failure and move straight to the next. Only rest once all exercises in the Tri-Set are complete.

Forced Reps

This is where you take your set until failure, and then get your partner to continue to assist you by putting pressure on the barbells, dumbbells, or machines in order to help you continue doing more repetitions. Aim for 5 extra repetitions at the end of each set after failure with the help of your partner.

Heavy Eccentrics

This is where you take 120% of your 1 rep max. Yes, 120% of your 1 rep max. This is very heavy and this technique should not be used often. Load it onto a Barbell for a Bicep Curl, and get your partner to assist you with the concentric (lifting the barbell to your chest) and then you carry out the eccentric portion of the movement (lowering the bar) unassisted and try to do slow 4 second declines. Aim for 5 repetitions for 3 sets.

This will shock and grow the muscles very heavily at this weight and intensity.

Push Day Advanced Training Techniques

AG Lateral Raises Dropset

Do 15 repetitions of Lateral Raises, then pick up a lighter dumbbell and do 15 more repetitions without resting. Then take a minutes rest. Do this Dropset 3 times in total.

Triceps Buster

This is a mega set including multiple different exercises with no rest. Triceps Cable Pushdown 3 x 15 reps into 3 x 15 Behind Head Cable Extensions. Into 3 x 15 Bench Dips and finally 3 x 15 Single Arm Dumbbell Extension. Beginners can start with the first two exercises as a superset (the cable pushdowns into extensions with no rest), and then graduate to the full mega set once they build strength.

Shoulder Press Machine Tri – Set

Do a set on the Shoulder Press Machine, and directly after with no rest pick up a weight plate and do Front Raises. After the Front Raises, do Upright Row with a Barbell or the same plate without rest.

Shoulder Press Machine 12 Reps into
Plate Front Raises 15 Reps into
Plate or Barbell Upright Row 10 Reps

Pull Day Advanced Training Techniques

AG Military Dropset

I learned this from a military man in the gym. Take an EZ bar and do 15 repetitions. After this, drop off some weight plates, try to remove about **50%** of the weight from the bar, take no rest and do another 15 repetitions. Do 3 sets of this.

Try and load the bar with **smaller** plates to make it easier to drop the weight by 50% each time. For example set 1 could be 10kg with a bunch of 2.5kg plates, and then set 2 you would drop off a plate from **each side**, leaving the weight on each side halved and weighing 5kg.

AG Back Tri Set

Barbell Row x 12
T – Bar Row x 15
One Arm Dumbbell Row x 12

This is a **time saving technique** I use on back day.

Position yourself in a rack. Start with a Barbell Row. Hit 10 – 12 reps on this exercise.

Then pick up one side only of the same barbell and use it as a T – Bar row.

As you are only lifting one half of the barbell, this drops the weight by approximately 50%, you can do **more** repetitions than before. Therefore, hit 15 repetitions of this exercise.

Then take a **dumbbell** that you keep nearby, and use the nearby surface of the rack to rest your hands against, and perform one-arm dumbbell rows for 12 reps each arm. This is a really fast way to hit **3 different** back exercises rapidly on a busy day in the gym, and all you need to do is to stay within **1 rack**.

As an **alternative** to this technique, you can also do a Standing Barbell Row, straight into a Standing Dumbbell Row, straight into an Inverse Bodyweight Row on a barbell racked in a rack, at about chest height, with your knees bent for a lower and more challenging angle.

Forearm Finisher

Do Barbell Reverse Curls, and then pick up a lighter barbell and do Wrist Curls forwards and backwards whilst holding the weight out in front of you.

Do one single Wrist Curl forwards and then one backwards, and do this repeatedly until it burns and you fail. Do 3 sets of the Reverse Curls into the Wrist Curls.

Push Day Advanced Training Techniques

Leg Destroyer

Leg Press 12 reps
6 Walking Dumbbell Lunges each Leg walk over to the:
Leg Extension Machine 15 reps
456
Go between these machines 3 times.

20 Reps Of Pain

1 set of 20 reps on the Hack Squat machine. Even with no weight added to the machine, this is a hard challenge to finish. Or more sets if you are brave enough...

Calves Destroyer

Machine 1: Seated Calve Raise Machine
2: Standing Calve Raise Machine
3: 45 Degree Leg Press Calve Raises
4: Free weight Exercise: Standing Dumbbell Calve Raises

If your gym allows for it, hit all these machines **one after the other!** You don't even have to do more than one or two sets of each, as long as you squeeze the rep for 4 seconds at the top of the movement, and go slowly back down, the burn will add up by the end.

Aim to go to failure at around the 15th rep in each set.

Abs Library

You can learn and pick a variety of ab workouts from this library. This stops you getting bored and gives you the choice to workout how you want when it comes to your abs. The variety also helps your abs to grow by challenging them in different ways rather than doing the same workout all the time. You will feel each workout hit your abs slightly differently.

Abs 1 (Hypertrophy)

5 Minutes of Roman Chair Sit Ups
Or
Abs Machine 3 Sets Of 20

Abs 2 (AG Speed Abs)

4 Sets Of 50 Crunches As Fast As You Can

Advanced circuit version of Abs 2:
Decline Sit Ups x failure
Ab Wheel Rollout x failure
Speed Sit Ups As Fast As You Can x failure
(3 rounds of circuit)

Abs 3 (Bodyweight)

3 sets of 12 Leg Raises
5 L Sit attempts

Abs 4 (Hypertrophy)

Decline Sit Ups with a weight plate until failure
Into Ab Wheel Rollouts until failure
Into Fitness Ball Sit Ups until failure Perform 3 rounds.

Abs 5

Hanging Leg Raises 3 Sets Of 12
Ab Wheel Rollouts 3 Sets Of 12

Abs 6 (Explosive)

Decline Sit Ups (Explosively Pushing
A Barbell Into The Sky) 3 Sets Of 12

Captains Chairs Leg Raises With A Dumbbell
On Your Feet (until failure)

Go as fast as you can on the Captains Chair Leg Raises, do 5 repetitions and then try to launch the dumbbell out of your feet as far as you can each time. Then keep going with the leg raises until failure. Picture each repetition as though you are trying to launch the dumbbell as far as you can.

Abs 7 (Burnout)

Roman Chair Sit Ups 3 x failure
Stability Ball Sit Ups 3 x failure
Medicine Ball V Ups 1 x failure
Decline Sit Ups With BarBell Explosive 3 x failure
Abdominal Curl Machine 3 x 12

Abs 8 (AG 6 Minute Abs Workout)

This is a challenging circuit that burns, but it adds size to abs very fast.

Leg Raises 30s
Flutter Kicks 30s
Planks 30s
Plank Ups 30s
(3 Rounds – 6 Minutes Total With No Rest)

Abs 9 (Time Under Tension Circuit)

Arnold's Abs Giant Set:

Hanging Straight Leg Raises – 20 reps

Hanging Knee Ups – 20 reps

Crunches – 50 reps

Seated Leg Tucks – 30 reps

Stick Twist – 100 reps

Do not take rest in this set!

Within the AG4 system, you can also do 5 minutes of Abs work from the “6 Pack Shortcuts” accelerator programme found in the programs section. This programme will show you how to progress your abdominal exercises to advanced levels, ensuring you are making your abdominal workouts more difficult each week instead of staying at the same intensity.

Easy Days

I want to introduce the concept of easy days. We all have jobs. We all have times where we probably won't go to the gym unless it's made to be a simple choice for us. We all have times where our bodies are simply tired. In these situations, you can implement easy days.

These are 30 minute days designed to just get you in the gym to be consistent, they will still grow you, but they are only 4 exercises as not to be intimidating workouts that you have to "figure out" from a long listed timetable.

They are just quick simple days to build into your muscle memory, go in and use these days often when you feel drained. A 30 minute quick and effective workout is better than no workout in nearly all cases despite severe injury, or if you ran a marathon the day before, this fact remains true.

Push Easy Day:

DB Incline Chest Press 3 x 12
DB Incline Shoulder Press 3 x 12
DB Lateral Raise 3 x 15
Triceps Extension 3 x 15

Pull Easy Day:

Pull Ups 3 x 12
Barbell Row 3 x 12
Rear Delt Fly Machine 3 x 12
Biceps Curl 3 x 12

Legs Easy Day:

Leg Press Machine 3 x 12
Leg Extension Machine 3 x 12
Lying Leg Curl Machine 3 x 12

Equipment Substitutions

On Push Day, depending on if you have more access to a lot of heavy weights that will challenge you in dumbbells or if you have access to heavy weights on the bench press, you will do that exercise first.

This program is heavily focused on improving your Dumbbell Incline Bench Press to develop your Upper Chest shelf aesthetics. However, let's say in a well equipped gym usually you can do 30kg dumbbells, but in your current location the dumbbells do not go that high, and you have access to a Bench Press, do the Bench Press first and heavy on your Push Day and the Dumbbells after.

If you have no access to heavy weights on your Bench Press, but have heavier dumbbells, then do the Incline Dumbbell Press first and the Bench after. Always ensure progressive overload and progression on at least one of these exercises every session (barbell or dumbbell chest press.) based on the most effective weights you have.

It is ideal to be consistent in terms of equipment wherever possible and go through consistent periods of working on one of these forms of chest press over the other if you really want to see a specific lift progress, but this is the protocol for when equipment conditions are less favorable.

Strategic substitutions also include doing Dumbbell Flys instead of Cable Flys or Chest Fly Machine if you are not in a well equipped gym.

Resistance Bands can be used for Triceps Pushdowns And Triceps Overhead Extensions.

Equipment Substitutions

On Leg Day, if you have absolutely no equipment to chose from, then Pistol Squat and assisted Pistol Squat practice is a valuable alternative. Multiple sets of this can grow your Leg muscles with limited equipment.

Nordic Hamstring Curls are also effective if you have some kind of mat to protect your knees. The Nordic Hamstring curls supersetted with Slow Bulgarian Split Squats with a 3 second Pause at the bottom. Even better if you can find some kind of 5kg weight or add weight to a Rucksack to hold, and do Single Leg RDL's with a 3 second Pause at the bottom and your Bulgarian Split Squats with the weight too.

Finally, your Squat Burnouts will include Wall Sits in the bottom of a Squat for 45 seconds and then go straight into 21s (7 lower half squats, 7 upper half squats, and then 7 full squats) for 3 total circuits can burn out your legs.

This can keep you growing in an environment where a well equipped gym is not accessible, however a well equipped gym would always be my first choice for the fastest growth.

Pull Day Substitutions - If you do not have access to a Rear Delt Fly Machine, you can perform a superset consisting of Dumbbell Rear Delt Fly and Resistance Band Face Pulls for 3 sets of 15 each.

Barbells can always be substituted for Dumbbells or Kettlebells for Bicep Curls.

Equipment Modifications

This programme is designed around training at a well equipped gym, however here are some common modifications you can make if faced with limitations around specific exercises.

Barbell Exercises – Exercises such as the Barbell Row, Barbell Bicep Curl can be replaced by Dumbbell variations of those exercises.

Dumbbell Exercises – Exercises such as the Dumbbell Shoulder Press and Incline Dumbbell Bench Press can be replaced by Barbell variations of those exercises.

Assisted Pull Up Machine – The first point of call would be to use a heavy resistance band. Use a step or box to give yourself the height required to step into the band, this will help you to do pull ups.

However if this is too challenging, using a bar in a squat rack, set at chest height, can allow you to do Floor assisted Pull Ups where your buttocks and feet touch the floor with your knees bent at the start of every repetition. You can produce the same motion as a pull up. Finally, simply using a bench, a box or another stable raised surface underneath a pull up bar can help you to do Pull Ups. Keep your legs on the raised surface and use them to help you do the pull up by straightening your legs on the way up, and bending your knees on the way down. Select the option that works best for your skill level.

Rear Delt Machine – The Dumbbell Rear Delt Fly can be used as a replacement for this machine. I find the machine smoother and allows me to push to a greater intensity than dumbbells, so to match this without the machine I would use a Superset of Rear Delt Dumbbell Flys (15 reps) straight into Resistance Band Face Pulls (15 reps). This is a solid alternative to work your Rear Delts.

Lateral Pulldown – Hooking a resistance band to a surface above can act as a Lateral Pulldown. Simply doing a Band Pull Apart with a resistance band starting from over your head can also act as a Lateral Pulldown.

Triceps Pushdown / Triceps Behind The Head Extension – Instead of Cables, Resistance Bands attached to an overhead surface such as bar or Squat Rack, make for an excellent alternative for these exercises.

Barbell Squats – Dumbbell Squats or the Leg Press Machine is always an option to replace this exercise.

Plateaus

At an intermediate stage, you may notice plateaus that you have to break through. A plateau is where you struggle to improve upon your record from the last week consistently.

As beginners we gain muscle really fast as we start weight training in the gym. But our body has limits to how much muscle it can hold, Over time, as we near the natural limits of our bodies in terms of how much muscle we can build, progress starts to slow down.

You may be putting 2.5kg on the bar each week in your first few months, but things can slow down. You may be going up by 3 repetitions every exercise, and that slows down to just 1 repetition per workout and you may stay at the same weight just adding 1 repetition each week for a while until you go up in weight every few weeks.

This is normal. You may notice that exercises that used to make you feel “worked out” after don’t really bring you as much feeling of activation anymore. You may notice a feeling of chasing the “pumping” feeling more as this is an indicator that you have worked yourself hard.

A plateau is when you can barely even get 1 extra repetition each week and have been stuck for an extended period of time trying to improve on an exercise. This is detrimental.

How To Break A Plateau

I suggest applying advanced training techniques on your isolation exercises to shock your muscles weekly. Adding extra sets each week can also help, so if you can’t go up in weight, add a few more extra repetitions in 1 additional set. Adding an extra “Heavy day” to the gym where you go in and hit heavy repetitions of an exercise in the 5 repetition range for 4 sets can also help. Finally, if the plateau is really bad, perform assistance exercises which are exercises that will specifically get you stronger on the exercise you are struggling with.

For example:

- **Weighted Dips and Close Grip Bench Press to improve the Bench Press.**
- **Lateral Pulldown to improve Pull Ups.**
- **Farmer Carries and Bar Hangs for Deadlifts.**

How Not To Break A Plateau

I will always say that at any level, the gym should feel challenging and you should be beating records, but it should always feel challenging in a good way. There should be a therapeutic feeling a lot of the time too. The gym shouldn't feel like torture. You can make a lot of gains by lifting weights very slowly in the 8 - 15 rep range and feeling a nice slow therapeutic burn and enjoying yourself rather than jumping around explosively everywhere or trying to powerlift a 1 rep max all the time.

Breaking plateaus often comes from just a simple extra day designed to beat plateaus in the gym, using the correct assistance exercises, but not overworking yourself to exhaustion daily.

Many people try to break a plateau by going 100% "powerlifting style" with really heavy sets of 1 - 5 reps daily. But we are working in the 8 - 12 rep range for bodybuilding which is more relaxing.

Try to stay in this range and the gym will feel therapeutic whilst still growing you. If you do run into a plateau, try to fix it with assistance exercises, extra sets and really push for that extra repetition each week. If you are really struggling, you can implement one heavy day.

Your week should consist of 30% of the total sets in the heavy Powerlifting range. Still keep 70% of your total work in the 8 - 12 bodybuilding "hypertrophy" range. You are trying to beat a plateau in the 8 - 12 range, so spend the majority of your time there, and use the 30% strength work to give you a little boost.

Don't turn every workout into a "Heavy" strength workout in the 1 - 5 rep range. It's exhausting and removes that therapeutic feeling from the gym. If you just do strength all the time, it gets very hard on the central nervous system, you get exhausted. It's a different style of training that can make a plateau worse if you don't know what you are doing. A little goes a long way here! Keep the 70 - 30 hypertrophy to strength sets rule and you should see effective results!

1 heavy day a week can help, and sometimes even a deload which is a week where you take a rest from the gym every 8 weeks can also help you come back stronger too.

Chasing The Pump

I encourage chasing "the pump" on your isolation exercises after you hit your Personal Records on the compound exercises. Do this by experimenting with advanced training techniques, and supersets chaining two different exercises together to see which exercise combinations shock your muscles the most.

You will find that chasing the "pump" feeling is a good indicator of exercise combinations that work for you to achieve muscle growth. Chasing this feeling isn't the only driver of growth, but chasing it for your isolation exercises after hitting records on your compounds is a good recommendation.

This pumping feeling tends to act as feedback that you have done an effective workout. Chasing that feeling constantly tends to ensure you progress when paired with hitting Personal Records on compound lifts. It suggests that you are challenging yourself enough in your isolations to grow your muscles, which in turn leads to your compound lifts going up in weight

Years 4 and 5 Of Your Training

Well done, you have now completed your training to an intermediate level.

At this stage you have built up a wide knowledge of bodybuilding and cardio techniques. You have the base of knowing how to craft and build a great body for life.

As long as your lifts keep going up, you will continue to see progress. Try to develop a love for fitness incorporating the sports you enjoy, the cardio sessions you enjoy, and keep experimenting with the advanced training techniques to find out what works for you.

If you want to take this all to the next level, and you find yourself with more time and really enjoy working out, the Advanced programme builds on all that we have learned. It is an extension of this programme, 5 days a week, with the option for 4 days, the sessions last longer which will add to your results and more exercises have been added.

To take your training to the advanced stages, you need 3 things:

Time. (1 hour + sessions)

A passion for fitness built up.

Experience of a fundamental programme like this built up. - So you can manage physically and mentally.

You should see 10 - 20% faster results if you train on an advanced programme (provided you stick to sessions with consistency.)

It can be the difference between looking great on the beach with a slight 6 pack and great muscles, to having the 6 pack look more "shredded" and chiseled and having the chest and shoulders slightly bigger. Going from looking great, to the top 10%.

30 - 45 minutes is where MOST growth happens, and 60 - 90 minutes is the sweet spot for natural lifters to maximise daily potential. If you have the time and passion, maybe a potential photoshoot coming up, you can move to the advanced program to see if it works for you.

Time starved individuals usually tend to be more consistent and actually work harder with four 30 or 45 minute simple workouts a week, producing better results.

Those who have a big passion for fitness and love to workout for extended periods of time for 4 - 6 days a week will usually gain better on an advanced AG4 programme.

Ultimately, whatever you decide, your body will build and look great even if you stay on the 30 minute routines. But for those that want more, you can maximise even more. It's all down to personal preference.

Once you find the perfect balance of what works for YOU in your fitness, you build an enjoyable and constantly growing environment for yourself, and this can make you feel good and turn fitness into a passion that grows for the rest of your life. Stay hitting records, hit your protein intake targets, and enjoy your results!

Which Workout Plan To Pick – Men's



YEAR 1
BEGINNER

• AG BEGINNERS 3X A WEEK



• FULL BODY 3X A WEEK



YEAR 2 - 3
INTERMEDIATE

• AG INT 4 DAY A WEEK



• AG INT 5 DAY A WEEK



• FULL BODY 3X A WEEK



ATHLETE

• ATHLETE PROGRAMME



Year 1: For your first year of training, I suggest my Beginner programme as it is my most digestible programme for beginners at 3 x per week. Every month the programme covers a new technique to learn and add to your training. Full Body or 30 Minute workouts are both great choices.

Year 2 - 3: I suggest you run an AG Intermediate programme for either 4 or 5 days a week. This programme covers more advanced forms of cardio, and has you in the gym more, perfect if you want to enjoy the mental benefits of going to the gym 4 - 5 days a week. If it suits you better to stick to 3 days a week, you can also stick with a 3x a week full body.

Athlete / Years 3-5: I suggest you check out the 5 day AG Athlete programme.